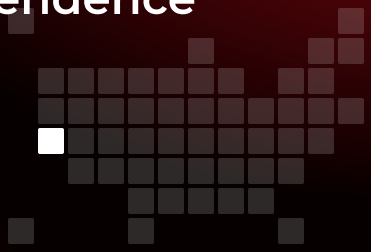
California

Talent Flows and International Dependence

Institutions, students, degrees, international talent, money, outcomes and migration, 1980–2025



California's 456 degree-granting institutions enrolled 2.68 million students in fall 2024, 14% of the U.S. total, and awarded 10,100 STEM master's degrees to international students in 2025. This profile follows the state's two streams of talent, the students it develops at home and those it draws from abroad, and sets both against the nation and the states closest to it in size.

Key Takeaways

1. **International students earn 48% of California's STEM master's degrees,** 4.5 points below the U.S. (52%) in 2025, ranking 23rd of 51 on dependence. The share is 38% for STEM research doctorates (U.S. 43%) and 8.4% for STEM bachelor's (U.S. 6.6%).
2. **California awarded 10,100 STEM master's degrees to international students in 2025,** 8.7% of the U.S. total and 3rd of 51 among states. Since 2015 the count changed +63%, against 2.2× nationally.
3. **The heaviest dependence is in computer & info sciences,** where international students earned 60% of master's degrees (7,356 degrees; U.S. 65%). 2 STEM fields with at least 50 master's graduates are majority-international.
4. **Among states of similar size,** California ranks 4th of 5 on the international share of STEM master's: California 48%, Texas 62%, New York 64%, Florida 40%, Illinois 66%.
5. **90% of California's first-time students in fall 2024 were state residents** and 3.7% came from abroad. More residents left for other states (42,872) than students arrived from them (18,752), a net loss of 24,120; the top destination for those leaving was Arizona.

California – By the Numbers:

MEASURE	2015	LATEST	CHANGE	U.S.	RANK
INTERNATIONAL TALENT					
First-time students whose home is outside the US	5.1%[2016]	**3.7%[2024]**	−1.4 pp ▼	3.1%	#9
STEM master's degrees earned by international students	6,220	**10,100[2025]**	+63% ▲	117,000	#3
Share of all US international STEM master's degrees	12%	**8.7%[2025]**	−2.9 pp ▼	100%	#3
International share of undergraduate enrollment	3.8%	**2.4%[2024]**	−1.3 pp ▼	3.0%	#29
International share of graduate enrollment	17%	**18%[2024]**	+0.6 pp ▲	17%	#16
International share of all bachelor's	4.9%	**5.5%[2025]**	+0.6 pp ▲	4.1%	#8
International share of STEM bachelor's	6.1%	**8.4%[2025]**	+2.3 pp ▲	6.6%	#5
International share of all master's	18%	**22%[2025]**	+4.3 pp ▲	22%	#15
International share of STEM master's	44%	**48%[2025]**	+3.4 pp ▲	52%	#23
International share of computer & information sciences master's	60%	**60%[2025]**	+0.2 pp ▲	65%	#28
International share of engineering & eng. technology master's	49%	**48%[2025]**	−0.7 pp ▼	50%	#19
International share of mathematics & statistics master's	43%	**50%[2025]**	+6.9 pp ▲	55%	#16
International share of biological & biomedical sciences master's	13%	**19%[2025]**	+5.2 pp ▲	23%	#24
International share of physical sciences master's	16%	**27%[2025]**	+11.1 pp ▲	33%	#27
International share of all research doctorates	20%	**25%[2025]**	+4.5 pp ▲	25%	#31
International share of STEM research doctorates	32%	**38%[2025]**	+6.2 pp ▲	43%	#32
International share of computer & information sciences research doctorates	54%	**51%[2025]**	−2.2 pp ▼	56%	#19
International share of engineering & eng. technology research doctorates	46%	**55%[2025]**	+8.7 pp ▲	55%	#21
International share of mathematics & statistics research doctorates	36%	**50%[2025]**	+13.9 pp ▲	53%	#16
International share of biological & biomedical sciences research doctorates	16%	**16%[2025]**	−0.7 pp ▼	23%	#38
International share of physical sciences research doctorates	25%	**33%[2025]**	+8.7 pp ▲	38%	#28
STEM & FIELD MIX					
STEM master's degrees per research doctorate	4.0	**4.7[2025]**	+16% ▲	6.4	#33
STEM share of bachelor's	20%	**27%[2025]**	+6.5 pp ▲	24%	#12
Share of bachelor's in computer & information sciences	2.6%	**6.2%[2025]**	+3.6 pp ▲	6.9%	#21
Share of bachelor's in engineering & eng. technology	6.0%	**7.1%[2025]**	+1.1 pp ▲	6.8%	#20
Share of bachelor's in mathematics & statistics	1.4%	**2.0%[2025]**	+0.6 pp ▲	1.2%	#2
Share of bachelor's in biological & biomedical sciences	6.5%	**7.6%[2025]**	+1.1 pp ▲	6.6%	#12
Share of bachelor's in physical sciences	1.6%	**1.4%[2025]**	−0.1 pp ▼	1.3%	#12
Share of bachelor's in health professions	7.9%	**8.5%[2025]**	+0.7 pp ▲	12%	#45
Share of bachelor's in business	18%	**15%[2025]**	−3.7 pp ▼	19%	#47
STEM share of master's	18%	**24%[2025]**	+5.7 pp ▲	23%	#17
Share of master's in computer & information sciences	3.4%	**8.4%[2025]**	+4.9 pp ▲	10%	#23

Source: NCES, Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS).

MEASURE	2015	LATEST	CHANGE	U.S.	RANK
STEM & FIELD MIX (CONT.)					
Share of master's in engineering & eng. technology	9.9%	**9.6%**[2025]	−0.3 pp ▼	6.7%	#4
Share of master's in mathematics & statistics	1.1%	**1.5%**[2025]	+0.5 pp ▲	1.3%	#15
Share of master's in biological & biomedical sciences	1.3%	**2.3%**[2025]	+0.9 pp ▲	2.5%	#31
Share of master's in physical sciences	1.1%	**1.1%**[2025]	+0.0 pp ▲	0.8%	#20
Share of master's in health professions	11%	**13%**[2025]	+1.7 pp ▲	15%	#32
Share of master's in business	22%	**17%**[2025]	−5.7 pp ▼	21%	#42
STEM share of research doctorates	44%	**45%**[2025]	+1.3 pp ▲	39%	#19
Share of research doctorates in computer & information sciences	3.3%	**5.7%**[2025]	+2.4 pp ▲	4.2%	#10
Share of research doctorates in engineering & eng. technology	15%	**14%**[2025]	−0.9 pp ▼	14%	#21
Share of research doctorates in mathematics & statistics	2.7%	**2.7%**[2025]	−0.0 pp ▼	2.4%	#21
Share of research doctorates in biological & biomedical sciences	12%	**12%**[2025]	−0.0 pp ▼	10%	#23
Share of research doctorates in physical sciences	9.6%	**9.5%**[2025]	−0.1 pp ▼	7.1%	#15
Share of research doctorates in health professions	6.8%	**8.3%**[2025]	+1.5 pp ▲	12%	#29
Share of research doctorates in business	2.9%	**4.4%**[2025]	+1.5 pp ▲	5.6%	#17
ENROLLMENT					
Fall enrollment	2,690,000	**2,680,000**[2024]	−0.5% ▼	19,700,000	#1
Share of enrollment at public institutions	82%	**83%**[2024]	+0.9 pp ▲	73%	#22
Share of enrollment at for-profit institutions	6.7%	**5.7%**[2024]	−1.0 pp ▼	5.5%	#12
Share of students enrolled part-time	45%	**45%**[2024]	+0.5 pp ▲	39%	#11
Share of students who are graduate students	10%	**12%**[2024]	+1.7 pp ▲	17%	#46
Share of students enrolled exclusively online	9.5%	**26%**[2024]	+16.8 pp ▲	27%	#23
OUTCOMES					
Bachelor's degrees per 100 undergraduates	8.3	**9.1**[2025]	+0.8 ▲	12.3	#48
Six-year bachelor's graduation rate, 4-year institutions	66%	**70%**[2024]	+3.9 pp ▲	65%	#7
Completion within 150% of normal time, 2-year institutions	37%	**46%**[2024]	+9.2 pp ▲	41%	#12
PRICES & FINANCE					
In-state tuition & fees, public 4-year	$11,800	**$8,140**[2023]	−31% ▼	$9,710	#40
State & local appropriations per FTE, public institutions	$9,800	**$12,700**[2024]	+30% ▲	$11,400	#11
Tuition share of core revenue, public institutions	36%	**31%**[2024]	−5.4 pp ▼	43%	#43
Average full-time faculty salary (9/10-month)	$134,000[2016]	**$137,000**[2024]	+2.4% ▲	$106,000	#1
STUDENT MIGRATION					
First-time students who are in-state residents	88%[2016]	**90%**[2024]	+1.6 pp ▲	–	#3
Net student migration (per 100 resident first-time students)	−7[2016]	**−6**[2024]	+0.8 ▲	–	#41

Every measure in the State Talent Sheet. Superscript years mark the year observed. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest value). "pp" is percentage points. Dollar values are in 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Counts are rounded to three significant figures. Arrow colors indicate direction of change only.

Source: NCES, Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS).
Source: NCES, IPEDS, harmonized state panel; degree-granting institutions, Title IV participants from 1996.

SECTION 1

Institutions

83% #22
Students at public institutions, 2024
U.S. **73%** · +0.9 pp since 2015

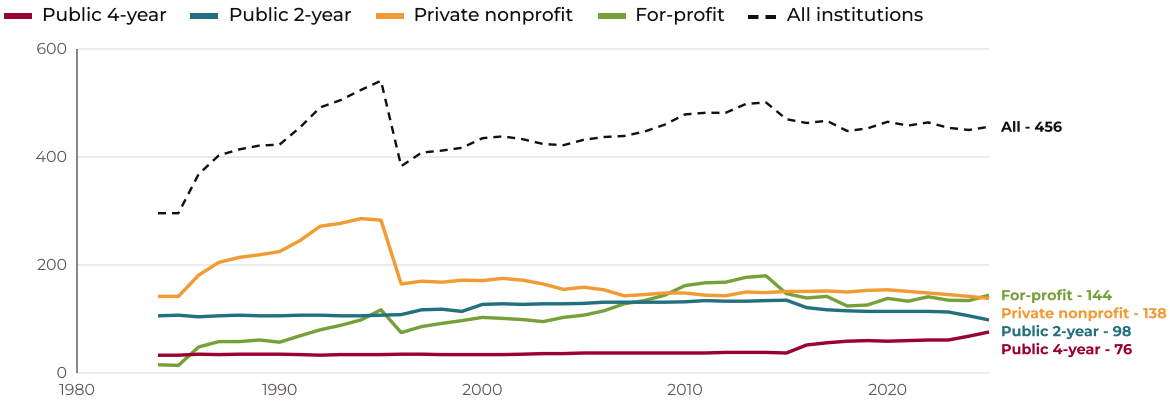
5.7% #12
Students at for-profit institutions, 2024
U.S. **5.5%** · −1.0 pp since 2015

26% #23
Students fully online, 2024
U.S. **27%** · +16.8 pp since 2015

California had 456 degree-granting institutions in 2025, compared with 470 in 2015: 76 public 4-year, 98 public 2-year, 138 private nonprofit, 144 for-profit. 83% of students attend public institutions (U.S. 73%) and 5.7% attend for-profit ones (U.S. 5.5%).

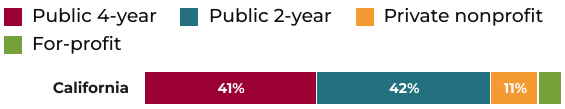
26% of students study exclusively online, about the same as the U.S. (27%), up 16.8 points since 2015. The institution count reflects openings, closures and mergers, and changes in which campuses report to IPEDS as degree-granting Title IV participants.

Figure 1 How Many Institutions Does California Have, by Sector?



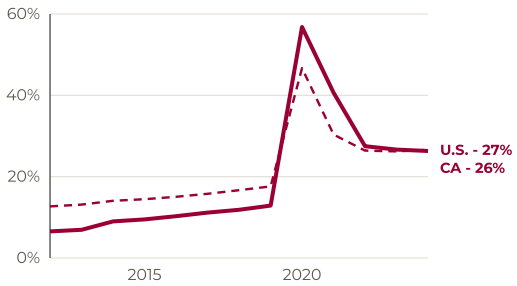
Degree-granting institutions located in the state, by sector. Data from NCES, IPEDS Institutional Characteristics, 1980–2025.

Figure 2 Where Do Students Enroll?



Share of fall 2024 enrollment by sector. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 3 How Many Students Study Only Online?



Share of students enrolled exclusively in distance education. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Source: NCES, Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS).

SECTION 2

Students

2,680,000 #1
Students enrolled, 2024
U.S. **19,700,000** · −0.5% since 2015

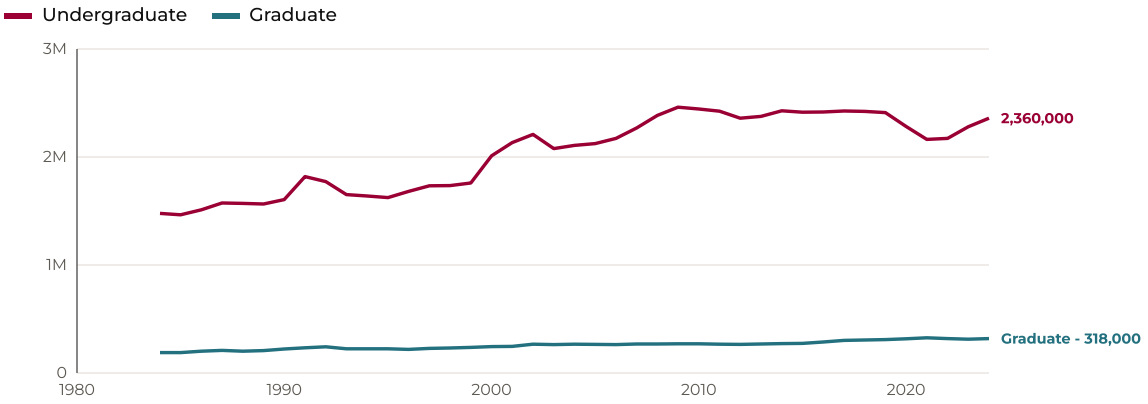
12% #46
Graduate share of students, 2024
U.S. **17%** · +1.7 pp since 2015

45% #11
Students attending part-time, 2024
U.S. **39%** · +0.5 pp since 2015

Institutions in California enrolled 2.68 million students in fall 2024: 2.36 million undergraduates and 318,372 graduate students. Total enrollment is roughly flat since 2015, and the state holds 14% of U.S. enrollment (1st of 51). Graduate students are 12% of the total, 4.9 points below the U.S. (17%).

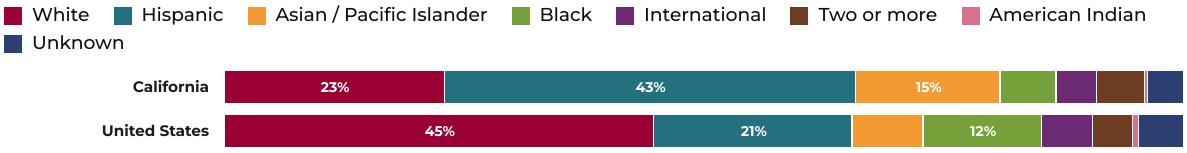
The largest groups of students are Hispanic (43%; U.S. 21%), White (23%; U.S. 45%), Asian / Pacific Islander (15%; U.S. 7.4%). 45% of students attend part-time, 5.9 points above the U.S. (39%).

Figure 4 How Has Enrollment in California Changed?



Fall headcount enrollment by level. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment, 1980–2024.

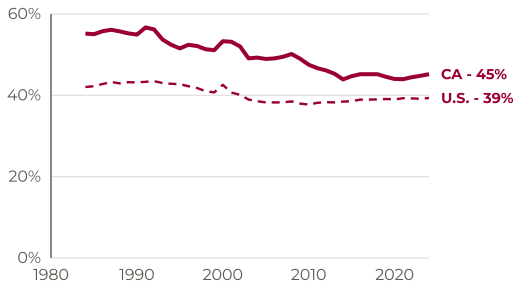
Figure 5 Who Enrolls in California?



Share of fall 2024 enrollment by race and ethnicity; "International" is U.S. nonresidents. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

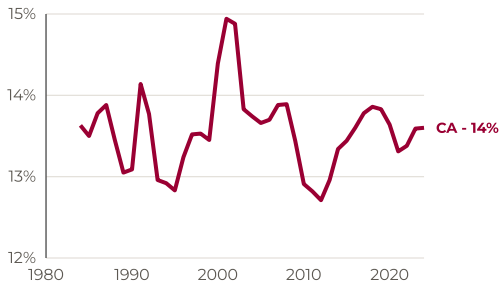
Source: NCES, Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS).

Figure 6 What Share of Students Attend Part-Time?



Part-time share of fall enrollment. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 7 What Share of U.S. Students Are in California?



State share of U.S. fall enrollment. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Source: NCES, Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS).

SECTION 3

International Students

18% #16
International share of grad students, 2024
U.S. **17%** · +0.6 pp since 2015

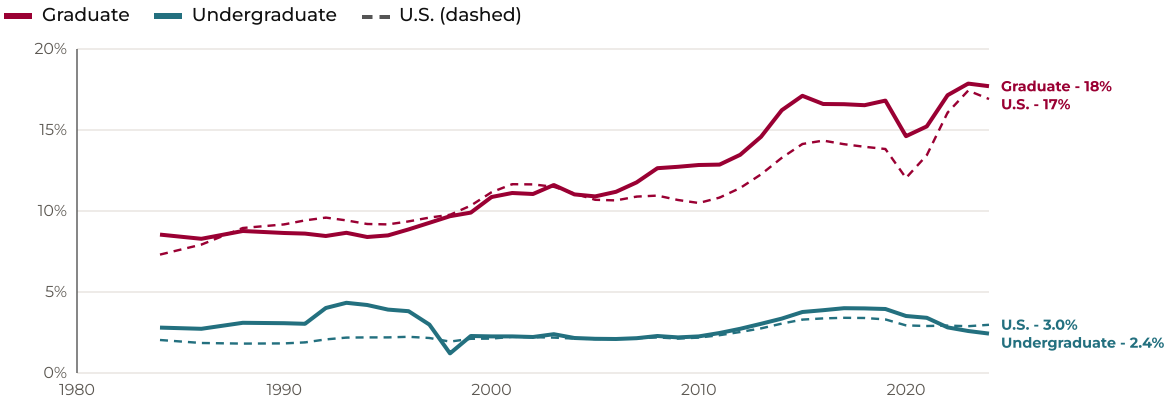
22% #15
International share of all master's, 2025
U.S. **22%** · +4.3 pp since 2015

48% #23
International share of STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **52%** · +3.4 pp since 2015

International students (U.S. nonresidents on temporary visas) make up 18% of California's graduate enrollment, 0.8 points above the U.S. (17%), and 2.4% of undergraduate enrollment (U.S. 3.0%). That is 56,346 graduate and 57,489 undergraduate students in fall 2024.

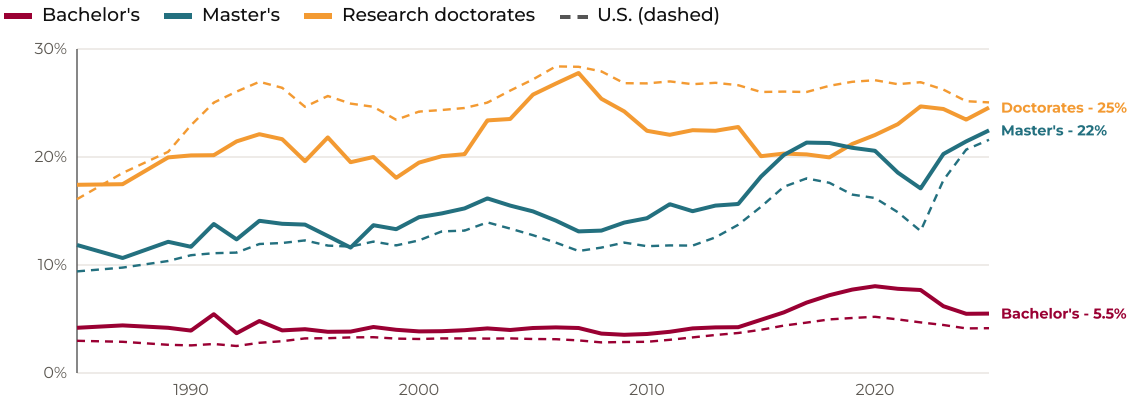
Dependence rises with the degree. International students earned 5.5% of bachelor's degrees, 22% of master's and 25% of research doctorates in 2025, against 4.1%, 22% and 25% nationally. In STEM fields they earned 4,775 bachelor's, 10,131 master's and 1,739 research doctorates; the state's share of all U.S. international STEM master's is 8.7% (3rd of 51).

Figure 8 How International Is California's Enrollment?



International (nonresident) share of fall enrollment, state (solid) and U.S. (dashed). Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

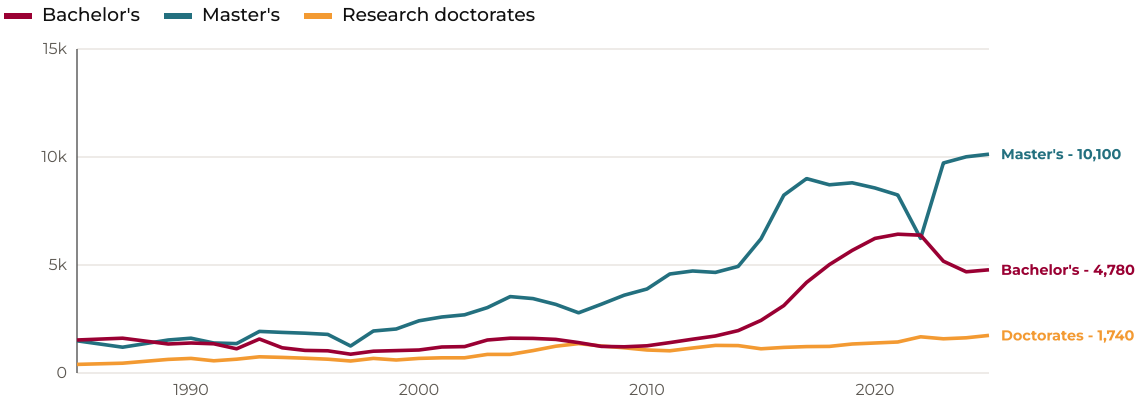
Figure 9 What Share of California's Degrees Go to International Students?



International share of degrees awarded, all fields, state (solid) and U.S. (dashed). Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

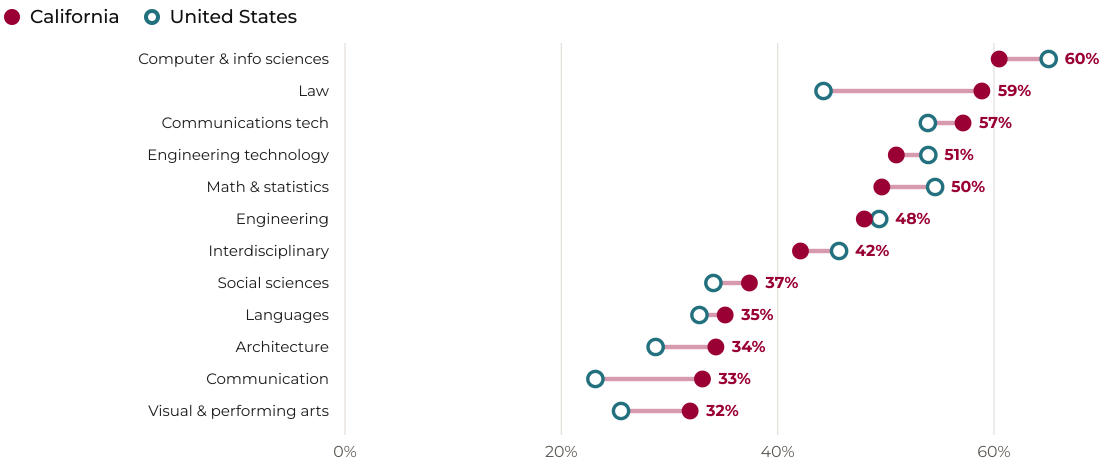
Source: NCES, Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS).

Figure 10 How Many STEM Degrees Do International Students Earn in California?



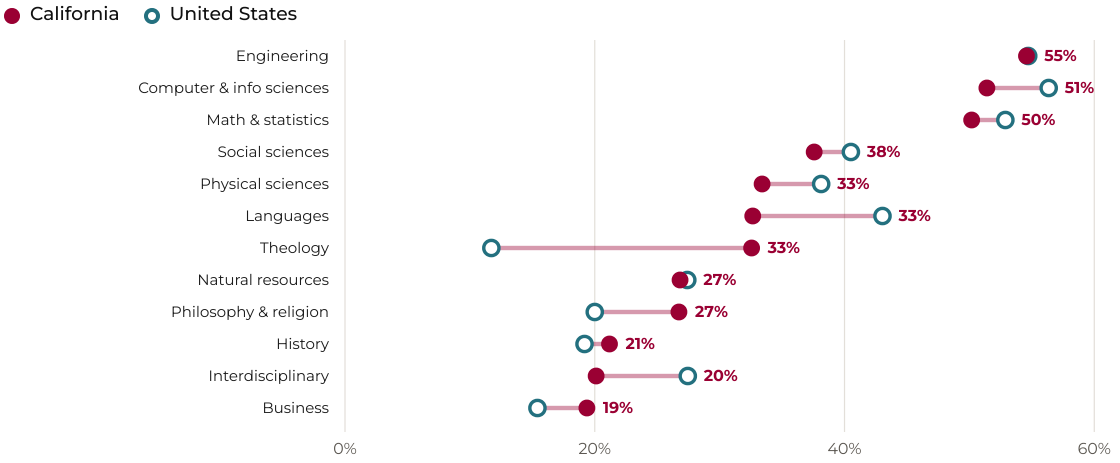
STEM degrees earned by international students, first majors. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Figure 11 Which Master's Fields Depend Most on International Students?



International share of master's degrees by field, 2025; fields with at least 30 graduates in the state. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Figure 12 Which Doctoral Fields Depend Most on International Students?



International share of research doctorates by field, 2025; fields with at least 30 graduates in the state. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Source: NCES, Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS).

SECTION 4

STEM Degrees

27% #12
STEM share of bachelor's, 2025
U.S. **24%** · +6.5 pp since 2015

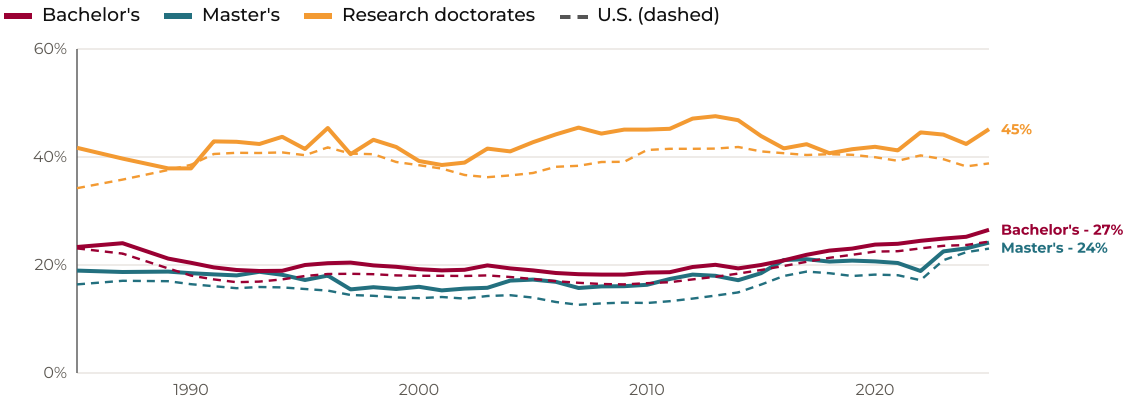
24% #17
STEM share of master's, 2025
U.S. **23%** · +5.7 pp since 2015

45% #19
STEM share of research doctorates, 2025
U.S. **39%** · +1.3 pp since 2015

STEM fields account for 27% of California's bachelor's degrees (12th of 51; U.S. 24%), 24% of master's (U.S. 23%) and 45% of research doctorates (U.S. 39%). In 2025 the state awarded 56,879 STEM bachelor's, 21,262 STEM master's and 4,530 STEM research doctorates, 9.5% of the nation's STEM master's.

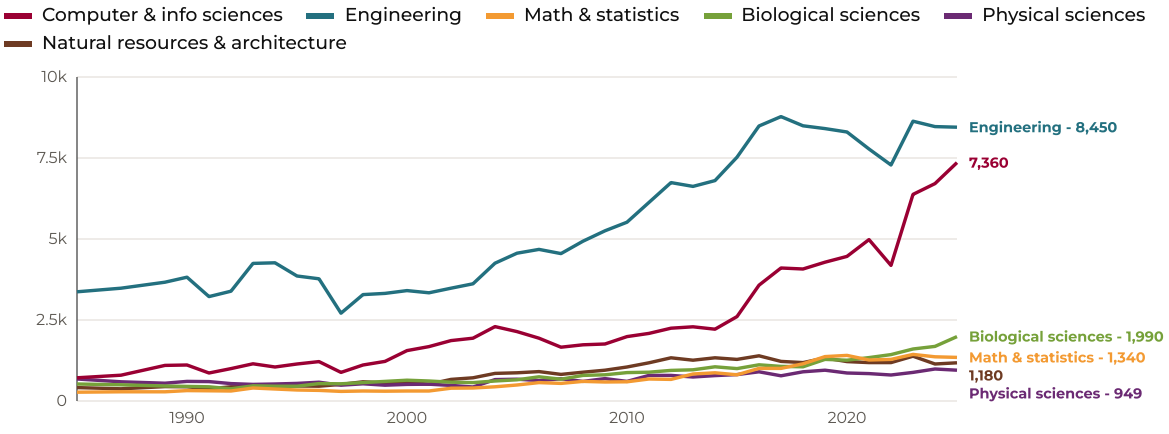
Graduate output relative to undergraduate output shows how far the state trains beyond the bachelor's: California produces 37.4 STEM master's for every 100 STEM bachelor's (U.S. 45.6) and 8.0 STEM doctorates (U.S. 7.1), with 4.7 STEM master's per STEM doctorate.

Figure 13 How Much of California's Degree Output Is STEM?



STEM share of degrees awarded by level, state (solid) and U.S. (dashed). Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

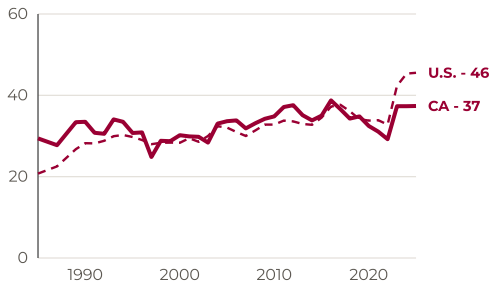
Figure 14 Which STEM Fields Produce California's Master's Degrees?



STEM master's degrees by field, all students. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

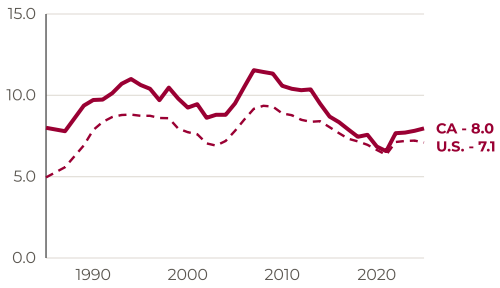
Source: NCES, Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS).

Figure 15 STEM Master's per 100 STEM Bachelor's



STEM master's awarded per 100 STEM bachelor's. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 16 STEM Doctorates per 100 STEM Bachelor's



STEM research doctorates per 100 STEM bachelor's. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Source: NCES, Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS).

SECTION 5

International × STEM

10,100 #3
International STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **117,000** · +63% since 2015

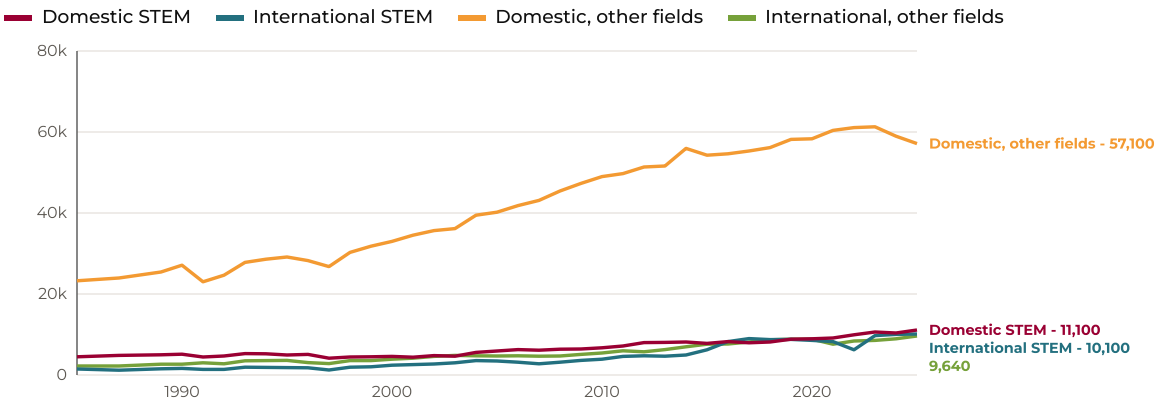
8.7% #3
Share of U.S. international STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **100%** · −2.9 pp since 2015

60% #28
International share of CS master's, 2025
U.S. **65%** · +0.2 pp since 2015

Between 2015 and 2025, California's STEM master's degrees changed by 7,223: 3,915 to international students (6,216 to 10,131) and 3,308 to domestic students (7,823 to 11,131). International students earn 48% of STEM master's but 14% of master's in other fields (U.S. 52% and 12%).

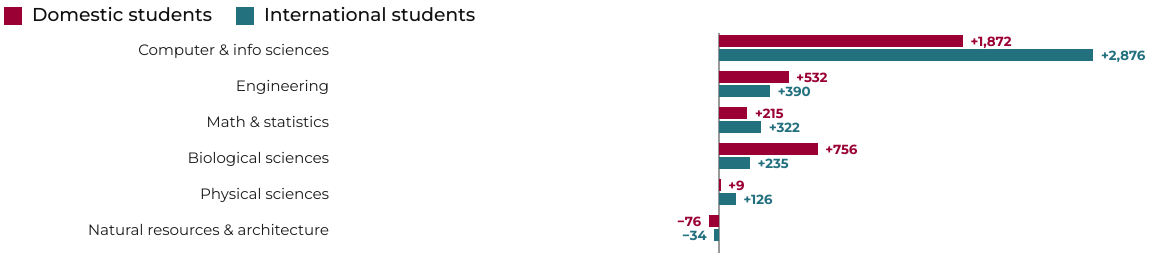
Women earn 36% of the STEM master's awarded to international students and 39% of those awarded to domestic students (U.S. 36% and 40%). California holds 8.7% of the nation's international STEM master's and 10% of its domestic ones.

Figure 17 Who Earns California's Master's Degrees?



Master's degrees by student residency and field group. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

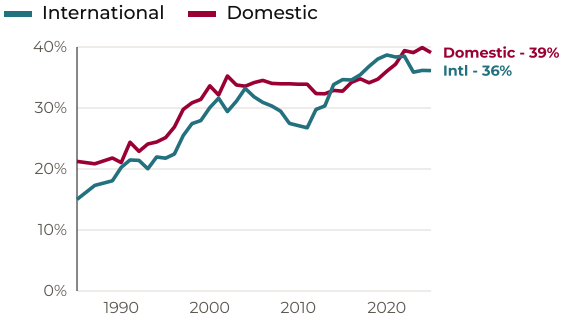
Figure 18 Where Did California's STEM Master's Growth Come From?



Change in STEM master's degrees by field, 2015–2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

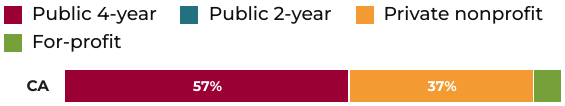
Source: NCES, Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS).

Figure 19 Women's Share of STEM Master's



Women's share of STEM master's, by student residency. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 20 Which Sectors Train International STEM Master's?



International STEM master's by sector, 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Table 1 How International Is Each STEM Field, by Degree Level?

Field	Bachelor's	U.S.	Master's	U.S.	Doctorates	U.S.
Computer & info sciences	**11%** 13,377 deg.	8.6%	**60%** 7,356 deg.	65%	**51%** 572 deg.	56%
Engineering	**6.5%** 14,208 deg.	7.2%	**48%** 7,676 deg.	49%	**55%** 1,389 deg.	55%
Engineering technology	**9.5%** 1,076 deg.	4.5%	**51%** 773 deg.	54%	**–** 11 deg.	42%
Math & statistics	**23%** 4,378 deg.	17%	**50%** 1,344 deg.	55%	**50%** 275 deg.	53%
Physical sciences	**8.8%** 3,082 deg.	6.0%	**27%** 949 deg.	33%	**33%** 955 deg.	38%
Biological sciences	**4.3%** 16,244 deg.	3.4%	**19%** 1,988 deg.	23%	**16%** 1,211 deg.	23%
Natural resources	**4.8%** 3,207 deg.	2.0%	**13%** 412 deg.	17%	**27%** 82 deg.	27%
Architecture	**8.8%** 1,307 deg.	7.3%	**34%** 764 deg.	29%	**31%** 35 deg.	55%

International share of degrees in each STEM field, 2025; small figures are total degrees in the state. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

SECTION 6

Fields of Study

6.2% #21
Bachelor's in computer science, 2025
U.S. **6.9%** · +3.6 pp since 2015

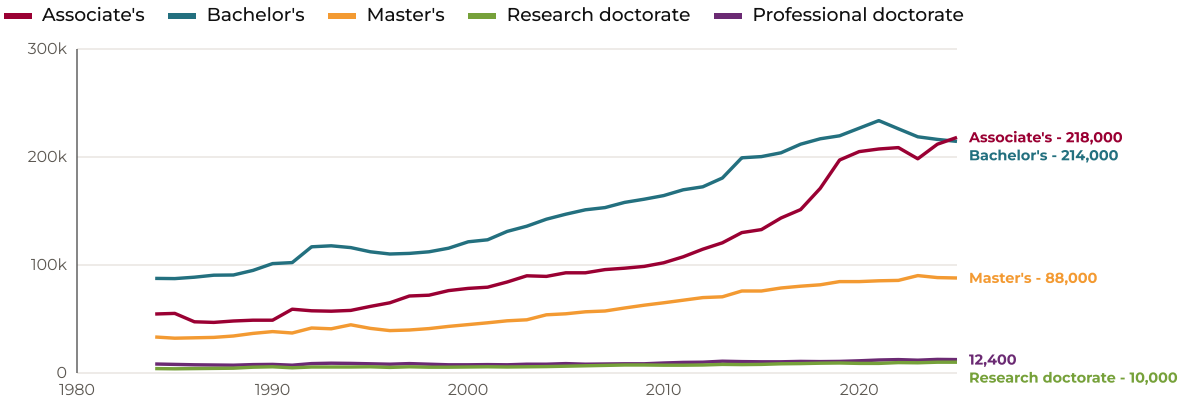
7.1% #20
Bachelor's in engineering, 2025
U.S. **6.8%** · +1.1 pp since 2015

15% #47
Bachelor's in business, 2025
U.S. **19%** · −3.7 pp since 2015

California awarded 218,232 associate's degrees, 214,417 bachelor's degrees, 88,043 master's degrees, 10,035 research doctorates, 12,395 professional doctorates in 2025. Relative to the nation, its bachelor's degrees are most concentrated in area & ethnic studies (2.33× the U.S. share), math & statistics (1.74× the U.S. share), social sciences (1.67× the U.S. share).

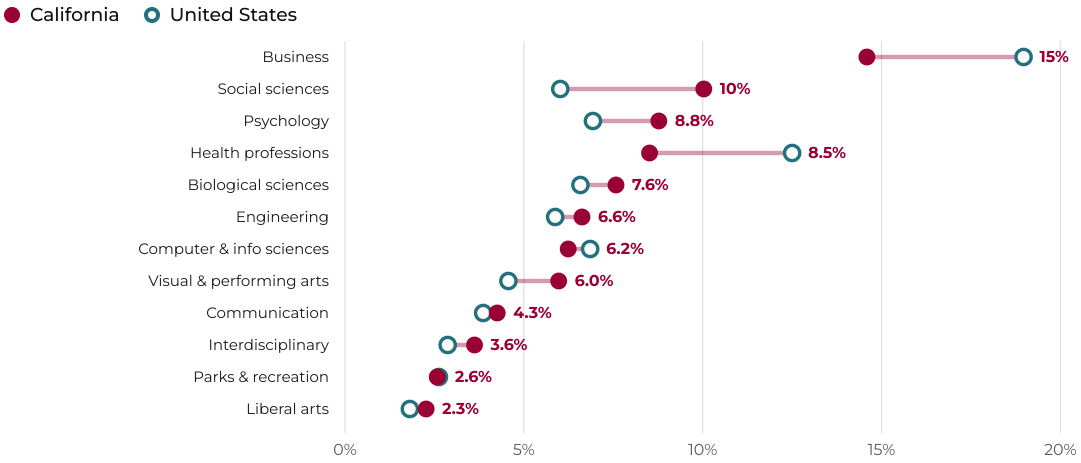
The field mix shows what the state's graduates are trained to do. A location quotient above 1 means a field is a larger share of the state's degrees than of the nation's; below 1, smaller.

Figure 21 How Many Degrees Does California Award?



Degrees awarded by level, first majors. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

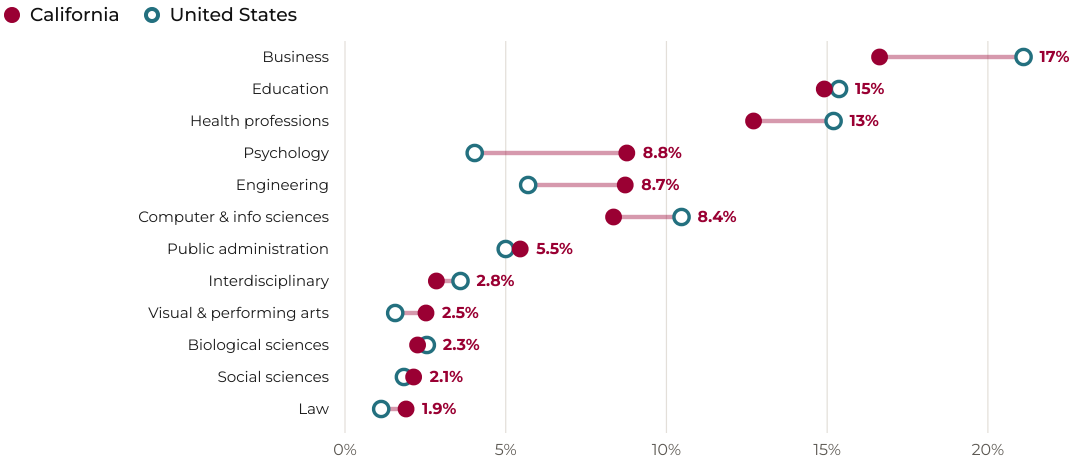
Figure 22 What Do California's Bachelor's Graduates Study?



Share of bachelor's degrees by field, 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Source: NCES, Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS).

Figure 23 What Do California's Master's Graduates Study?



Share of master's degrees by field, 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Table 2 Where Is California Most Specialized?

Field	Bachelor's LQ	State share	U.S. share	Degrees
Area & ethnic studies	**2.33**	0.7%	0.3%	1,455
Math & statistics	**1.74**	2.0%	1.2%	4,378
Social sciences	**1.67**	10%	6.0%	21,499
Communications tech	**1.52**	0.4%	0.3%	867
Languages	**1.38**	0.8%	0.6%	1,709
Natural resources	**1.34**	1.5%	1.1%	3,207
Visual & performing arts	**1.31**	6.0%	4.6%	12,810
Family & consumer sci.	**1.28**	1.1%	0.8%	2,253
Psychology	**1.27**	8.8%	6.9%	18,811
Interdisciplinary	**1.26**	3.6%	2.9%	7,764

Location quotient = state share of bachelor's in the field ÷ U.S. share; fields with at least 50 degrees. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

SECTION 7

Prices and Finance

$8,140 #40
In-state tuition, public 4-year, 2023
U.S. **$9,710** · −31% since 2015

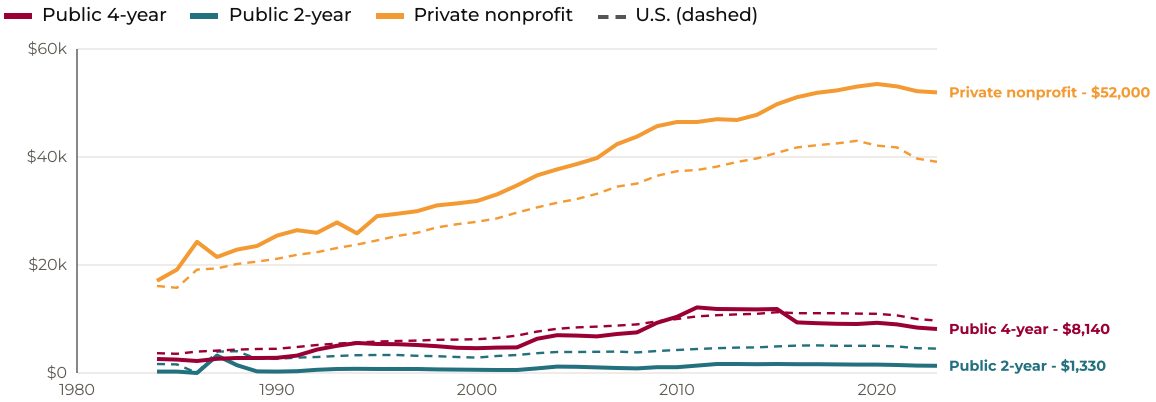
$12,700 #11
Appropriations per student, 2024
U.S. **$11,400** · +30% since 2015

31% #43
Tuition share of public revenue, 2024
U.S. **43%** · −5.4 pp since 2015

In-state tuition and fees at California's public four-year institutions averaged $8,140 in 2023, 16% below the U.S. ($9,710); out-of-state students paid $24,800 (U.S. $23,400). Tuition at public two-year colleges averaged $1,330 and at private nonprofits $52,000. All values are in 2024 dollars.

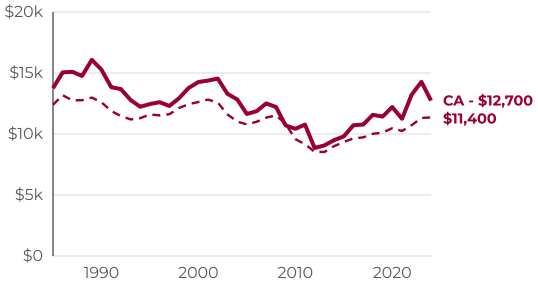
State and local appropriations to public institutions came to $12,700 per full-time-equivalent student in 2024 (11th of 51; U.S. $11,400), up 30% since 2015. Net tuition supplies 31% of public institutions' core revenue, 12.3 points below the U.S. (43%).

Figure 24 What Does In-State Tuition Cost in California?



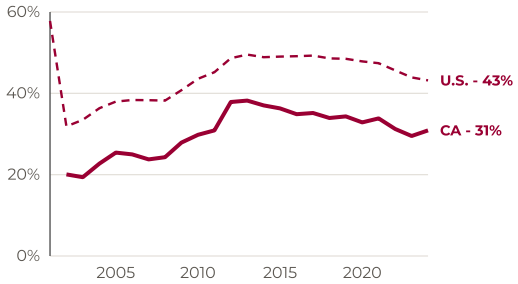
Average undergraduate in-state tuition and fees, 2024 dollars; state (solid) and U.S. (dashed). Data from NCES, IPEDS Institutional Characteristics.

Figure 25 Appropriations per Student



State and local appropriations per FTE, public institutions, 2024 $. Data from NCES, IPEDS Finance.

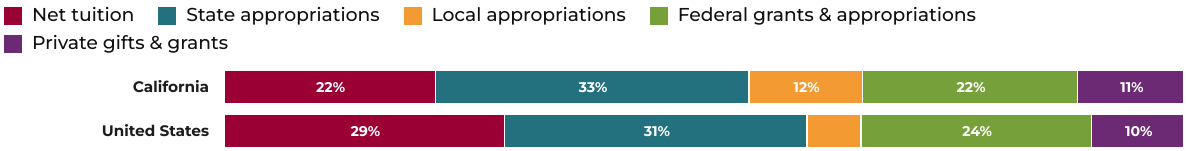
Figure 26 Tuition's Share of Core Revenue



Net tuition as a share of core revenue, public institutions. Data from NCES, IPEDS Finance.

Source: NCES, Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS).

Figure 27 How Are California's Public Institutions Funded?



Per FTE student, 2024	Net tuition	State appropriations	Local appropriations	Federal grants & appropriations	Private gifts & grants
California	**$6,300**	**$9,350**	**$3,390**	**$6,430**	**$3,170**
United States	$8,960	$9,640	$1,710	$7,360	$2,950

Core revenue sources per FTE student at public institutions, 2024 dollars. Data from NCES, IPEDS Finance.

Source: NCES, Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS).

SECTION 8

Student Outcomes

70% #7
Six-year graduation rate, 2024
U.S. **65%** · +3.9 pp since 2015

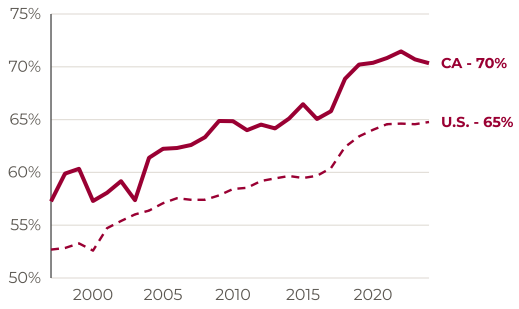
46% #12
Two-year completion rate, 2024
U.S. **41%** · +9.2 pp since 2015

9.1 #48
Bachelor's per 100 undergraduates, 2025
U.S. **12.3** · +0.8 since 2015

70% of students who started a bachelor's degree at California's four-year institutions finished within six years (cohort reported in 2024), 5.6 points above the U.S. (65%) and 7th of 51. At two-year institutions 46% completed within 150% of normal time (U.S. 41%). The state awards 9.1 bachelor's degrees per 100 undergraduates (U.S. 12.3).

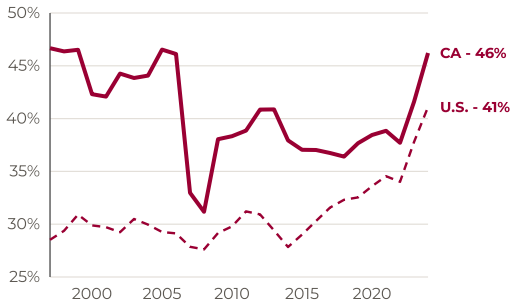
By sector, six-year rates are 72% at public 4-year institutions, 74% at private nonprofit institutions, 25% at for-profit institutions. Gaps by race and ethnicity are shown below for groups with at least 100 students in the cohort.

Figure 28 Six-Year Bachelor's Graduation Rate



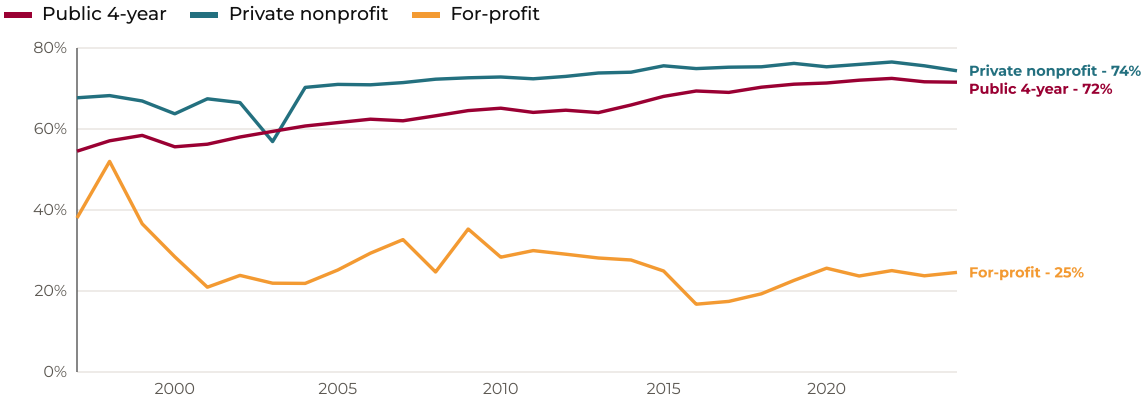
Completion within 150% of normal time, four-year institutions. Data from NCES, IPEDS Graduation Rates.

Figure 29 Two-Year Completion Rate



Completion within 150% of normal time, two-year institutions. Data from NCES, IPEDS Graduation Rates.

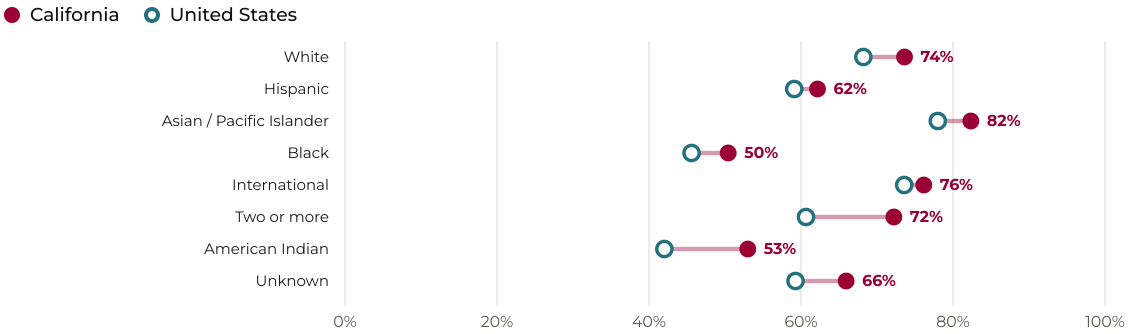
Figure 30 How Do Graduation Rates Differ by Sector?



Six-year bachelor's graduation rate by sector. Data from NCES, IPEDS Graduation Rates.

Source: NCES, Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS).

Figure 31 How Do Graduation Rates Differ by Race and Ethnicity?



Six-year bachelor's graduation rate by race and ethnicity, 2024. Data from NCES, IPEDS Graduation Rates.

Source: NCES, Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS).

SECTION 9

Faculty

$137,000 #1
Average faculty salary, 2024
U.S. **$106,000** · +2.4% since 2016

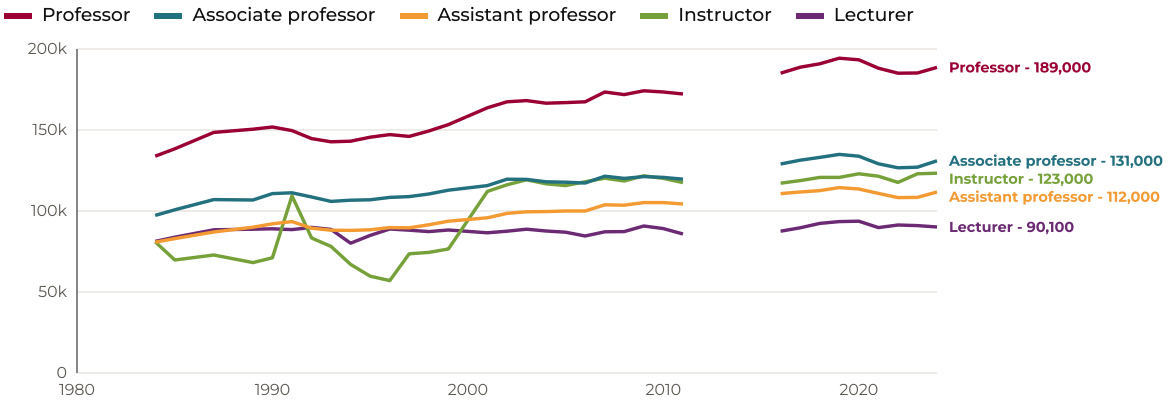
12% #46
Graduate share of students, 2024
U.S. **17%** · +1.7 pp since 2015

4.7 #33
STEM master's per doctorate, 2025
U.S. **6.4** · +16% since 2015

Full-time instructional faculty at California's institutions earned an average of $137,000 in 2024 on nine- or ten-month contracts (1st of 51), 29% above the U.S. ($106,000), up 2% since 2016.

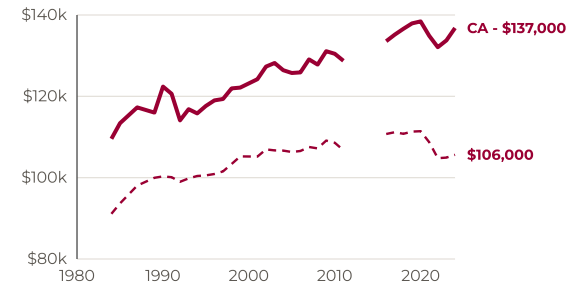
Of full-time instructional staff in 2024, 47% were tenured, 16% were on tenure track, 33% were not on tenure track, 4.0% were no faculty status. Faculty counts by rank are shown below.

Figure 32 How Many Faculty Does California Have, by Rank?



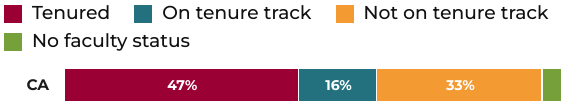
Full-time instructional faculty by academic rank. Data from NCES, IPEDS Human Resources.

Figure 33 Average Faculty Salary



Average salary, full-time instructional faculty, 2024 $. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 34 Tenure Status



Full-time instructional staff by tenure status, 2024. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Source: NCES, Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS).

SECTION 10

Student Migration

90% #3
First-time students from in state, 2024
U.S. **–** · +1.6 pp since 2016

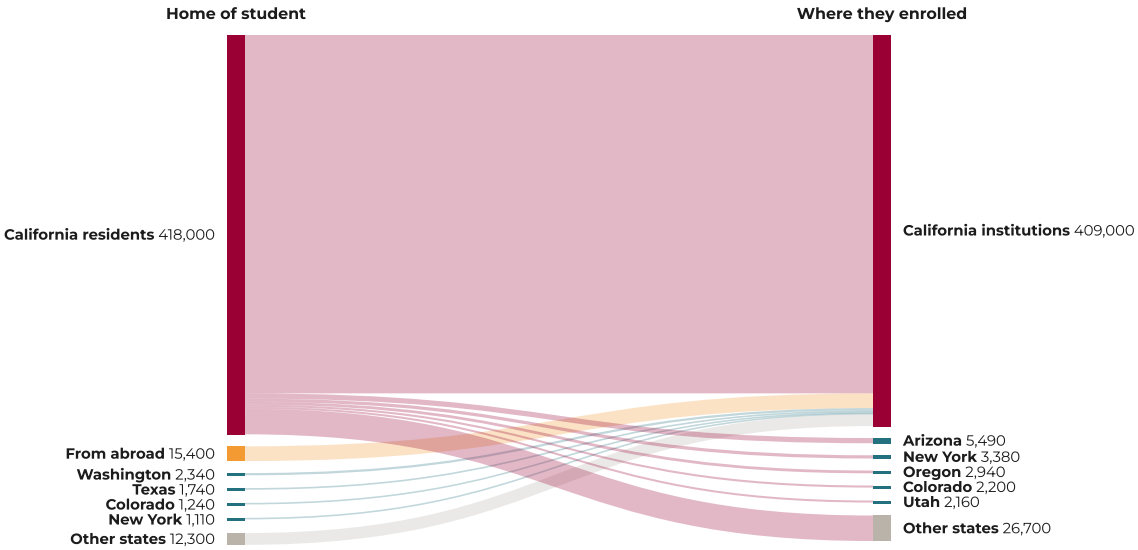
3.7% #9
First-time students from abroad, 2024
U.S. **3.1%** · −1.4 pp since 2016

−6 #41
Net migration per 100 residents, 2024
U.S. **–** · +0.8 since 2016

In fall 2024, 375,068 California residents began college at institutions in the state, 18,752 first-time students arrived from other states, 15,436 arrived from abroad, and 42,872 residents left to enroll elsewhere. 90% of the state's first-time students are residents (3rd of 51; U.S. –).

Net migration was −6 per 100 resident first-time students (41st of 51). The largest sources of arriving students were Washington (2,343), Texas (1,739), Colorado (1,237); the largest destinations for departing residents were Arizona (5,492), New York (3,381), Oregon (2,941).

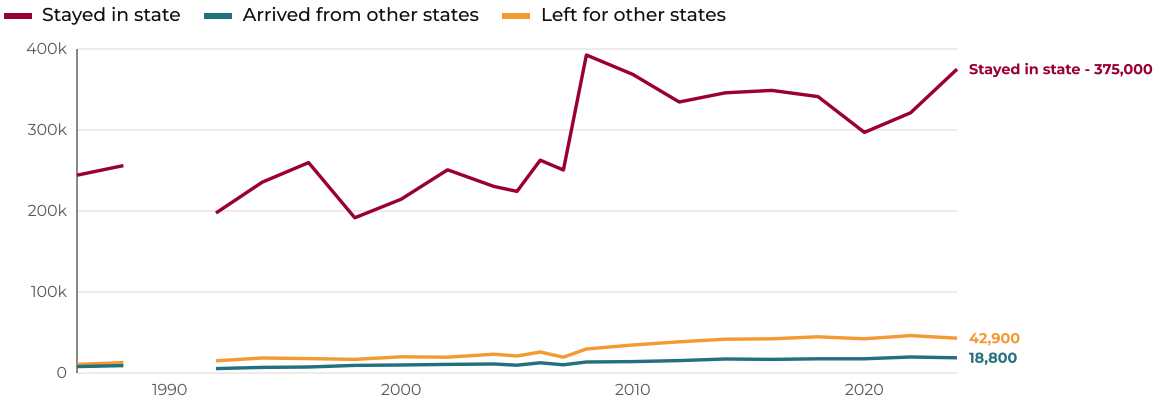
Figure 35 Where Do California's First-Time Students Come From, and Where Do Its Residents Go?



First-time degree-seeking undergraduates, fall 2024, by home (left) and state of the institution entered (right). IPEDS records students from abroad as one category, not by country. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

Source: NCES, Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS).

Figure 36 How Have California's Student Flows Changed?



First-time students by flow; even years before 2001; odd years with incomplete reporting are omitted. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

Table 3 Which States Exchange the Most Students With California?

Arrived from	Students	Left for	Students
Abroad	15,436	Arizona	5,492
Washington	2,343	New York	3,381
Texas	1,739	Oregon	2,941
Colorado	1,237	Colorado	2,195
New York	1,107	Utah	2,155
Oregon	1,091	Texas	2,029
Arizona	930	Massachusetts	2,005
Nevada	885	Washington	1,822
Hawaii	860	Indiana	1,520
Illinois	848	Pennsylvania	1,473
New Jersey	656	Illinois	1,413
Massachusetts	639	Idaho	1,054

First-time degree-seeking undergraduates, fall 2024. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 11

Competitors

48% #23
International share of STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **52%** · +3.4 pp since 2015

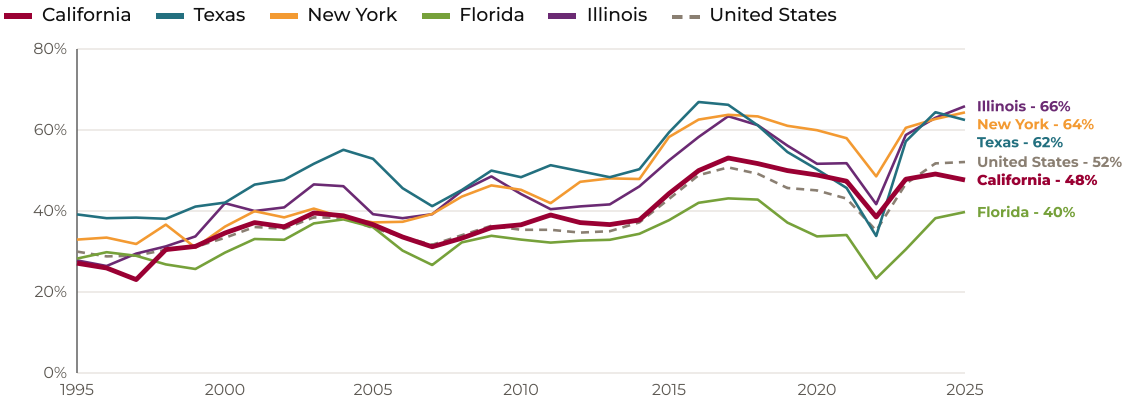
18% #16
International share of grad students, 2024
U.S. **17%** · +0.6 pp since 2015

24% #17
STEM share of master's, 2025
U.S. **23%** · +5.7 pp since 2015

The four states closest to California in total fall enrollment are Texas, New York, Florida, Illinois. Among them, California ranks 4th on the international share of STEM master's; Illinois is the most dependent at 66%.

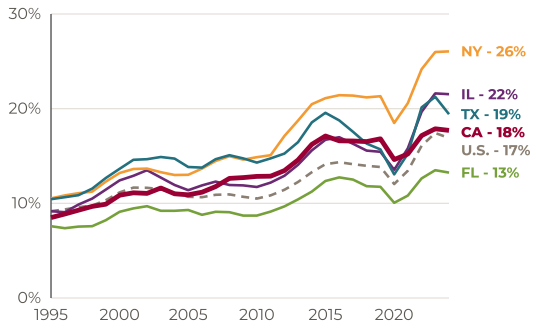
The table compares the five states on enrollment, STEM output, international dependence, completion, prices and migration. The interactive profile offers other peer sets, including region, economy size, output per person, 2024 presidential vote and student exchange.

Figure 37 How Dependent Are California and Its Peers on International STEM Master's Graduates?



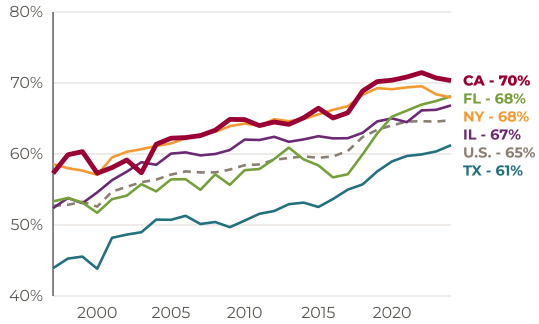
International share of STEM master's degrees. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions, 1995–2025.

Figure 38 International Share of Graduate Enrollment



Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

Figure 39 Six-Year Graduation Rate



Data from NCES, IPEDS Graduation Rates.

Source: NCES, Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS).

Table 4 How Does California Compare With States of Similar Size?

Measure	California	Texas	New York	Florida	Illinois	U.S.
Fall enrollment 2024	**2,680,000** **#1**	1,670,000 #2	1,150,000 #3	1,050,000 #4	723,000 #5	19,700,000
Share of students who are graduate students 2024	**12%** **#46**	13% #41	22% #7	13% #38	22% #6	17%
STEM share of bachelor's 2025	**27%** **#12**	24% #18	24% #19	22% #29	23% #24	24%
STEM share of master's 2025	**24%** **#17**	27% #12	26% #13	22% #22	23% #20	23%
STEM master's degrees earned by international students 2025	**10,100** **#3**	10,500 #2	13,700 #1	3,530 #12	7,390 #5	117,000
Share of all US international STEM master's degrees 2025	**8.7%** **#3**	9.0% #2	12% #1	3.0% #12	6.3% #5	100%
International share of STEM master's 2025	**48%** **#23**	62% #9	64% #7	40% #28	66% #5	52%
International share of STEM research doctorates 2025	**38%** **#32**	50% #9	46% #16	47% #12	54% #4	43%
International share of graduate enrollment 2024	**18%** **#16**	19% #12	26% #3	13% #25	22% #7	17%
International share of undergraduate enrollment 2024	**2.4%** **#29**	2.5% #28	5.6% #4	4.4% #6	3.8% #11	3.0%
Six-year bachelor's graduation rate, 4-year institutions 2024	**70%** **#7**	61% #26	68% #13	68% #12	67% #19	65%
In-state tuition & fees, public 4-year 2023	**$8,140** **#40**	$8,520 #38	$8,670 #37	$4,390 #51	$15,000 #9	$9,710
State & local appropriations per FTE, public institutions 2024	**$12,700** **#11**	$11,800 #18	$15,900 #8	$12,000 #15	$10,300 #29	$11,400
Average full-time faculty salary (9/10-month) 2024	**$137,000** **#1**	$96,800 #24	$117,000 #9	$97,400 #22	$112,000 #11	$106,000
First-time students who are in-state residents 2024	**90%** **#3**	92% #1	73% #22	81% #9	80% #10	–
Net student migration (per 100 resident first-time students) 2024	**−6** **#41**	−10 #43	−4 #38	+1 #33	−19 #48	–

Small figures are ranks among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). Dollar values in 2024 dollars. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Source: NCES, Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS).

SECTION 12

Institutions in Detail

2,680,000 #1
Students enrolled, 2024
U.S. **19,700,000** · −0.5% since 2015

10,100 #3
International STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **117,000** · +63% since 2015

70% #7
Six-year graduation rate, 2024
U.S. **65%** · +3.9 pp since 2015

California has 417 degree-granting institutions in the IPEDS universe. The tables list those that train the most international STEM graduates and the 15 largest by enrollment, with their international shares, STEM output, completion and selectivity.

Table 5 Which California Institutions Train the Most International STEM Graduates?

Institution	Intl STEM master's	Intl share	Intl STEM doctorates	Intl share	Intl share of grad students
University of Southern California Los Angeles · Private nonprofit	**2,134**	63%	202	52%	37%
University of California-Berkeley Berkeley · Public 4-year	**987**	43%	203	34%	31%
University of California-San Diego La Jolla · Public 4-year	**867**	52%	237	44%	44%
University of California-Los Angeles Los Angeles · Public 4-year	**622**	44%	209	43%	27%
Stanford University Stanford · Private nonprofit	**542**	35%	191	34%	36%
University of California-Irvine Irvine · Public 4-year	**455**	51%	140	38%	30%
San Jose State University San Jose · Public 4-year	**498**	53%	–	–	17%
Westcliff University Irvine · For-profit	**384**	91%	–	–	75%
University of California-Riverside Riverside · Public 4-year	**215**	49%	114	47%	39%
California State University-Long Beach Long Beach · Public 4-year	**318**	63%	–	–	11%
University of California-Davis Davis · Public 4-year	**151**	40%	140	37%	24%
California State University-Northridge Northridge · Public 4-year	**257**	59%	–	–	12%

Degrees awarded in 2025; enrollment shares from fall 2024. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Table 6 What Are California's Largest Institutions?

Institution	Enrollment	Intl share, grad	Intl share, undergrad	STEM bachelor's	Six-year grad rate	Admit rate
University of California-Los Angeles Los Angeles · Public 4-year	**47,335**	27%	7.7%	3,751	93%	9.0%
University of Southern California Los Angeles · Private nonprofit	**46,566**	37%	14%	1,650	92%	9.8%
University of California-Berkeley Berkeley · Public 4-year	**45,882**	31%	9.8%	5,542	93%	11%
University of California-San Diego La Jolla · Public 4-year	**44,256**	44%	11%	4,394	86%	27%
California State University-Fullerton Fullerton · Public 4-year	**43,662**	12%	1.1%	1,279	70%	91%
California State University-Long Beach Long Beach · Public 4-year	**42,003**	11%	2.4%	1,775	69%	46%
San Diego State University San Diego · Public 4-year	**41,137**	9.0%	2.4%	1,586	76%	36%
University of California-Davis Davis · Public 4-year	**40,065**	24%	13%	3,895	86%	42%
California State University-Northridge Northridge · Public 4-year	**38,313**	12%	2.9%	1,180	57%	93%
San Jose State University San Jose · Public 4-year	**37,661**	17%	3.8%	1,562	69%	85%
University of California-Irvine Irvine · Public 4-year	**37,297**	30%	12%	3,346	87%	29%
East Los Angeles College Monterey Park · Public 4-year	**33,677**	–	0.6%	–	–	–
California State University-Sacramento Sacramento · Public 4-year	**31,943**	8.0%	1.6%	1,319	56%	94%
Bakersfield College Bakersfield · Public 4-year	**30,746**	–	0.2%	26	–	–
American River College Sacramento · Public 2-year	**30,462**	–	0.2%	–	–	–

Fall 2024 enrollment; degrees 2025; graduation rates 2024; admissions 2024. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

NOTES

About These Data

International students

U.S. nonresidents (students on temporary visas), as IPEDS defines them. IPEDS does not record country of citizenship, so this profile shows where international students enroll and graduate, not where they come from. Permanent residents are counted with U.S. citizens.

STEM

CIP families 03, 04, 11, 14, 15, 26, 27 and 40. Doctorates are research and scholarship doctorates; professional doctorates appear only in the degree-count figure. Degrees are first majors only.

Universe

Degree-granting institutions located in the state; Title IV participants from 1996. Geography is the institution's location, not the student's home. Enrollment is fall headcount.

Migration

First-time degree-seeking undergraduates by home state, reported in even years before 2001 and every year since; odd years with incomplete reporting are omitted. Net migration is students arriving from other states minus residents leaving, per 100 resident first-time students.

Money

All dollar values are in 2024 dollars using the CPI-U. Appropriations and revenue are per full-time-equivalent student at public institutions.

Race and ethnicity

IPEDS did not collect race and ethnicity in every year before 2010, and categories changed in 2008–2010; “Two or more” exists only from then.

Peers

Comparison states are the four closest in total fall enrollment.

Source

National Center for Education Statistics, Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS): Institutional Characteristics, Fall Enrollment, Completions, Graduation Rates, Finance, Human Resources and Admissions components, 1980–2025, harmonized into a state panel. Generated November 2026.